

Aalap Tanna

Narrative and communications. Founder of Word Force, New York.
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Summary

Communications and content lead who starts things from zero. Built a streaming platform's content operation as employee number three: 25 original series, \$2M+ in production budgets, team from 3 to 15+, 500K+ downloads across 12 countries. Ran editorial strategy for a YouTube channel that shipped 960 videos and 20M+ views in ten months with no ad budget. Founded a narrative and communications studio in New York. Background in film, journalism, and advertising.

Experience

- Founder, Word Force (Word Force Advertising LLC), New York

March 2026 to present

 - Positioning, messaging and brand narrative for founders and owner-led businesses, including a publicly listed jewellery brand.
 - Communications consultancy for a national arts and fashion event: positioning, sponsor-facing narrative and campaign copy.
 - Advisory engagement with an AI marketplace startup on positioning and consent messaging.
 - Pro bono positioning and narrative for a New York health-data startup working with Cornell Tech: diagnosis document, current-vs-proposed positioning, stakeholder messaging.
 - Produced two live shows in New York: contracts, budgets, run sheets, production documentation.
 - Built and launched an AI search visibility audit service (GEO/AEO) for small brands.
- Head of Content (employee #3), streaming platform, Ahmedabad

2020 to 2023

 - Built the content operation from zero: commissioning, development, production oversight, editorial line.
 - 25+ original series; managed \$2M+ in production budgets; grew the content team from 3 to 15+.
 - Platform reached 500K+ downloads across 12+ countries; content library later acquired and licensed for US distribution.
- Founding Content Lead, Navi Savar (YouTube editorial channel), Ahmedabad

2023 to 2024

 - Editorial strategy, podcast curation, research. 960+ videos and 20M+ views in ten months; 72K followers, no paid media.
 - Retention writing, thumbnail and title testing, opening-sequence optimization across the full video library.
- Strategy Lead, Deloitte × SCADpro (USPS federal project), Atlanta

Mar to May 2025

 - Led a team of five on a federal strategy project; messaging recommendations accepted by the client.
- Strategic Communications, Nexerios (EV startup), remote

Sep to Nov 2025

 - Brand narrative, product messaging, investor pitch deck, journalist outreach.

Community and research

- Founder, Amdavad Font Book (2022 to present): a typography archive documenting hand-painted sign boards and crediting the painters by name. Papers on street typography; archival work with the Herb Lubalin Study Center, Cooper Union.
- Building a benchmark for cultural authenticity in generative AI: a reference corpus and scoring protocol for how image models handle non-Latin scripts, scored by native readers. Essay on the method at aalaptanna.com.
- Co-founder, GoodAIFilms.com: a community for filmmakers using AI with craft. Curation, interviews, workflow writing.

Skills and tools

Communications	Narrative and positioning, messaging architecture, press and journalist outreach, pitch decks, editorial strategy, house style guides.
Content, production	Commissioning, series structure, budgets to \$2M+, run sheets, contracts, video editing (DaVinci Resolve, Premiere), retention writing, Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Figma, Notion.
Growth	Titles and thumbnails, SEO and AI search visibility (GEO/AEO), Meta Ads, Google Ads, email.
AI tools	Claude, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Midjourney, Runway, Sora, Kling, Veo, ElevenLabs.
Languages	Gujarati, Hindi, English.

Education

MA in Advertising (STEM designated), SCAD, Atlanta. BFA in Film and Media, Annapurna College, Hyderabad.

Selected writing

Eleven essays on how fields explain themselves, published at aalaptanna.com. Includes *Write the objection first*, *Benchmarks are arguments*, *The second act problem*, and *Who gets to choose the metaphor*.